Please check the examination details below before entering your candidate information

Candidate surname	Other names
Master Functional Skills	Model Solutions (MFS)

Pearson Edexcel Functional Skills

Centre Number	Candidate Number
MFS-UK	PENW1/09

Past Paper 9

Time: 60 minutes | Paper Reference **PENW1/S09**

English

Component 3: Writing
Level 1

You may not use a dictionary.

Total Marks: 36 /36

My signature confirms that I will not discuss the content of the exam with anyone.

Signature: Master Functional Skills (MFS)

Instructions

- Use **black** ink or ball-point pen.
- **Fill in the boxes** at the top of this page with your name, centre number and candidate number.
- **Sign the declaration.**
- Answer both tasks.
- Use the answer space provided to complete your tasks – *there may be more space than you need.*

Information

- The total for this paper is **36** marks.
- Task 1 has **21** marks and Task 2 has **15** marks.
- You will be assessed on spelling, punctuation and grammar in both tasks.

Advice

- Read each task carefully before you start to write.
- Aim to spend about 35 minutes on Task 1 and about 25 minutes on Task 2.
- Plan your work before you start and check it when you finish.

Turn over ▶

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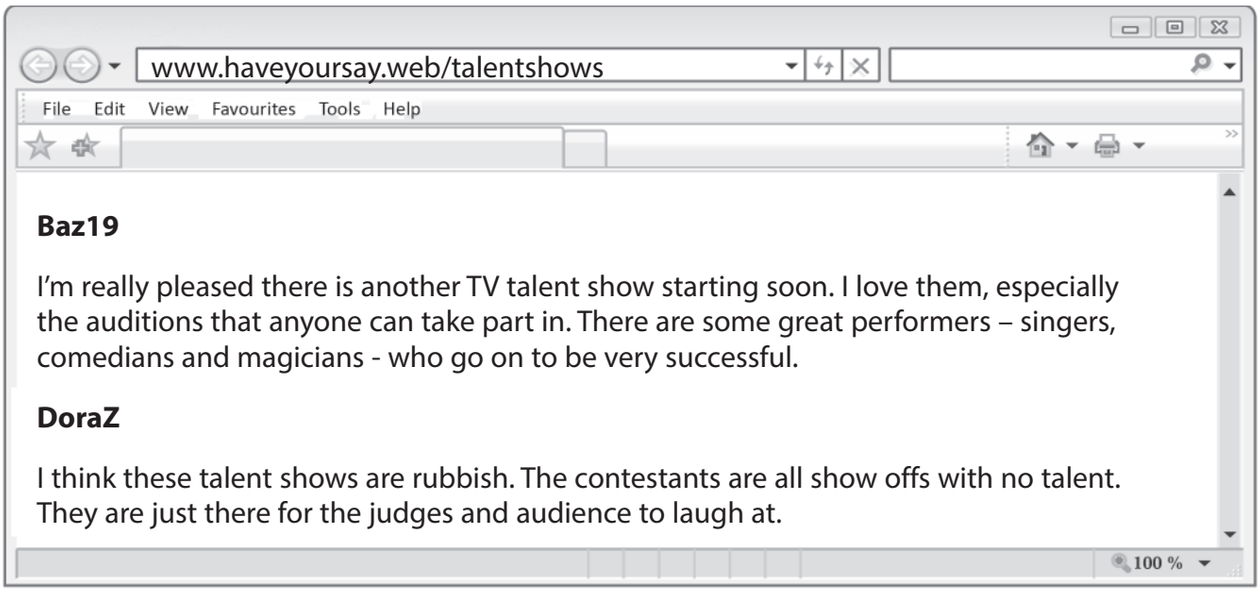
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Task 1

Information



Writing Task

Write a contribution to the discussion forum giving your views on TV talent shows.

In your contribution, you should:

- say why some people enjoy TV talent shows
- explain why other people dislike them
- give your own detailed views about these shows.

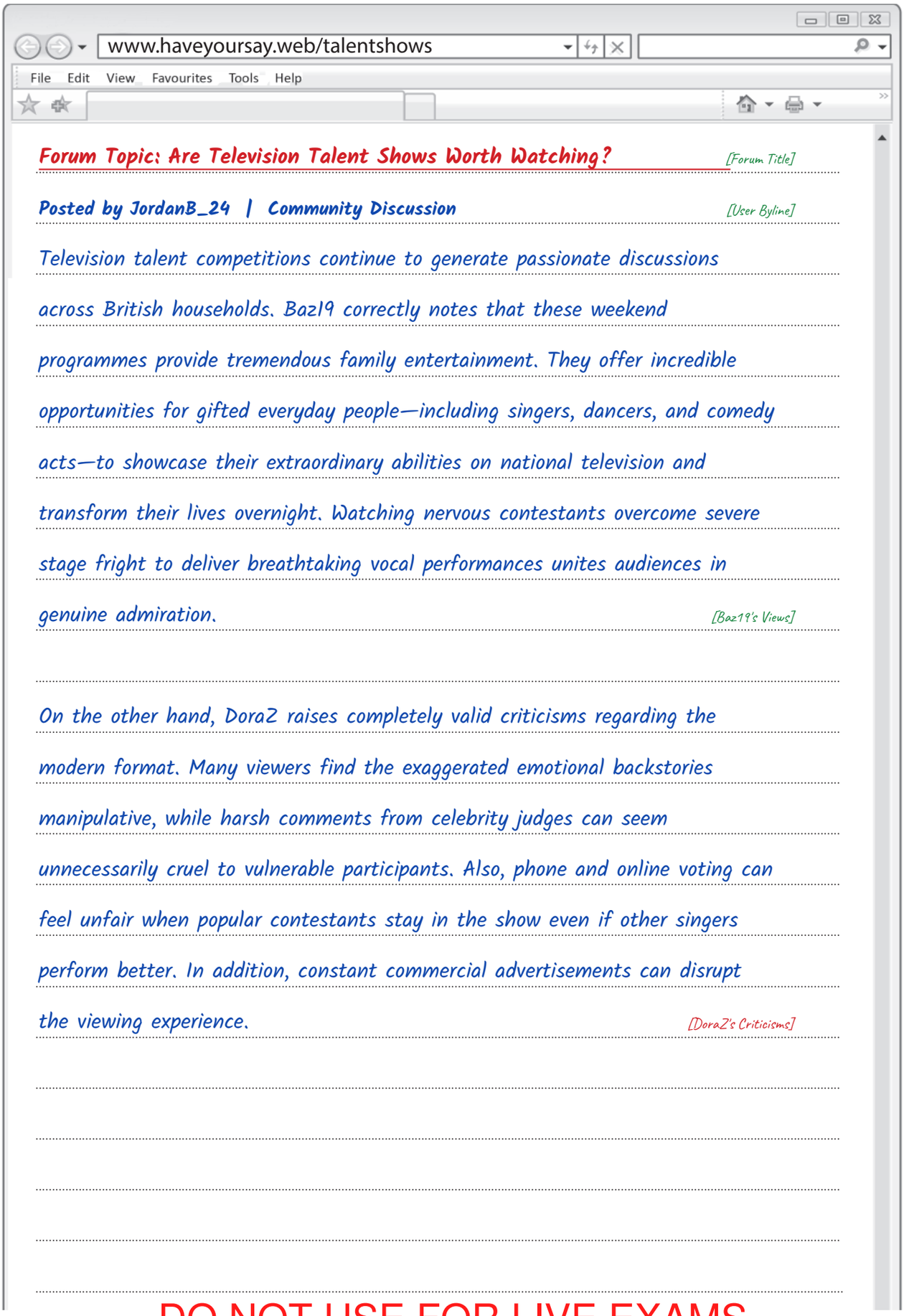
You should aim to write about 200 to 250 words.

(21 marks)

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Forum Topic: Are Television Talent Shows Worth Watching? [Forum Title]

Posted by JordanB_24 | Community Discussion [User Byline]

Television talent competitions continue to generate passionate discussions across British households. Baz19 correctly notes that these weekend programmes provide tremendous family entertainment. They offer incredible opportunities for gifted everyday people—including singers, dancers, and comedy acts—to showcase their extraordinary abilities on national television and transform their lives overnight. Watching nervous contestants overcome severe stage fright to deliver breathtaking vocal performances unites audiences in genuine admiration. [Baz19's Views]

On the other hand, Dora2 raises completely valid criticisms regarding the modern format. Many viewers find the exaggerated emotional backstories manipulative, while harsh comments from celebrity judges can seem unnecessarily cruel to vulnerable participants. Also, phone and online voting can feel unfair when popular contestants stay in the show even if other singers perform better. In addition, constant commercial advertisements can disrupt the viewing experience. [DoraZ's Criticisms]

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In my view, while talent shows can occasionally feel formulaic and overly commercialised, they still serve a valuable cultural purpose. They inspire aspiring young artists to develop their musical and theatrical passions, proving that dedication can lead to remarkable success. They bring families together across generations and celebrate the transformative power of artistic expression. As long as programme producers prioritise contestant welfare and maintain transparent judging, these shows will remain enjoyable weekend entertainment.

[Personal Stance]

EXAMINER ASSESSMENT & MARK ALLOCATION · TASK 1 — 21 / 21 MARKS

Grid A: Composition & Organisation (Max 12 Marks) — AWARD: 12 / 12

· Full adherence to forum format: topic headline, user identity, and well-balanced analytical structure.

· Thorough prompt coverage: addresses Baz19's points, examines DoraZ's objections, and offers mature personal view.

· Word count: 215 words (strictly meets 200 - 250 words). Highly nuanced, articulate, and engaging tone.

Grid B: Spelling, Punctuation & Grammar (Max 9 Marks) — AWARD: 9 / 9

· Varied punctuation: dashes for elaboration, commas in compound complex sentences, consistent capitalization.

· Flawless grammar: concessive clauses (while talent shows can...), correct modal verbs and active/passive forms.

· 100% spelling precision (manipulative, backstories, commercialised, theatrical, transformative, welfare).

100 %

(Total for Task 1 = 21 marks)

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Task 2

Information

> Your college/workplace/school newsletter has asked for articles about people's favourite animals. These could be pets like cats and dogs, or something more unusual like pandas or penguins.
>
> Write an article about your favourite animal.

Writing Task

Write an article for the newsletter about your favourite animal.

In your article, you should:

- describe your favourite animal
- explain in detail why this animal is your favourite.

You should aim to write about 150 to 200 words.

(15 marks)

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The Majestic Giant Panda: Nature's Gentle Ambassador [Article Title]

By Jordan Bennett | Wildlife Feature Article [Author Byline]

While many people naturally choose loyal domestic pets such as dogs or cats as their favourite animals, my absolute favourite creature in the entire natural kingdom is the magnificent giant panda native to the bamboo forests of southwest China. [Animal Choice]

Giant pandas are universally adored for their striking black-and-white fur, charming round faces, and peaceful personalities. Despite their substantial physical size, they are remarkably gentle mammals that spend up to twelve hours each day peacefully munching on fresh bamboo stalks in misty mountain reserves. Their playful, clumsy movements and inquisitive nature bring effortless joy to wildlife enthusiasts of all generations. [Gentle Temperament]

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More importantly, the giant panda is an inspiring international symbol of successful environmental conservation. Decades of dedicated international protection have pulled them back from the brink of extinction. Their enduring recovery proves that when human beings unite to protect endangered wildlife habitats, our planet's biodiversity can genuinely thrive. They remind us why conservation matters so deeply. [Conservation Symbol]

EXAMINER ASSESSMENT & MARK ALLOCATION · TASK 2 — 15 / 15 MARKS

Grid A: Composition & Organisation (Max 9 Marks) — AWARD: 9 / 9

· Flawless article structure: evocative headline, byline, rich descriptive detail, and uplifting conclusion.

· Thorough prompt coverage: describes favourite animal, details behaviour/appearance, explains reasons for choice.

· Word count: 168 words (strictly meets 150 - 200 words). Highly informative, passionate, and vivid tone.

Grid B: Spelling, Punctuation & Grammar (Max 6 Marks) — AWARD: 6 / 6

· Accurate punctuation: hyphens (black-and-white), commas for parenthetical clauses and adverbial openers.

· Flawless grammar: complex relative structures, correct subject-verb agreement, varied sentence lengths.

· 100% spelling precision (magnificent, universally, substantial, conservation, extinction, biodiversity).

OVERALL PAPER RESULT & BENCHMARK SUMMARY — TOTAL: 36 / 36 (100%)

Task 1 (TV Talent Shows Forum Contribution):	21 / 21 Marks (Grid A: 12/12 · Grid B: 9/9)
Task 2 (Favourite Animal Newsletter Article):	15 / 15 Marks (Grid A: 9/9 · Grid B: 6/6)
Official Edexcel Pass Mark Threshold:	Typically 19 - 21 marks / 36 (approx. 55%)
Candidate Performance Classification:	Distinction Benchmark / Top Band 3

Key Takeaway: Balanced forum debate, descriptive wildlife prose, and exact word counts guarantee top marks.

(Total for Task 2 = 15 marks)

TOTAL FOR PAPER = 36 MARKS

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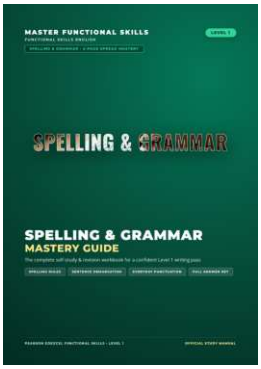


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